



How to Read Your Astrocartography Chart

A SELF-PACED GUIDE TO RELOCATION ASTROLOGY

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LUNAR PLAYGROUND

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At a Glance

Astrocartography maps your birth chart onto the globe, showing where specific planetary energies are strongest for you geographically. This guide teaches you to read your own map and use it to make informed decisions about where to live, travel, or relocate.

BY THE END OF THIS GUIDE, YOU WILL BE ABLE TO:

- Identify and interpret every planetary line on your chart
- Understand how the four angles (MC, IC, AC, DC) shape your experience in a location
- Evaluate any city using a structured framework
- Read line crossings (parans) and assess power zones
- Generate and interpret a relocated chart for deeper analysis
- Make practical relocation decisions using astrocartography as one informed input

WHAT YOU NEED TO BEGIN

REQUIREMENT	DETAIL
Birth date	Day, month, year
Birth time	As exact as possible (within minutes)
Birth location	City-level precision
Free chart tool	Astro.com or Astro-Seek.com

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PART I

Foundations

1. What Is Astrocartography

Astrocartography (also called relocational astrology or astro-mapping) is a branch of astrology that maps your birth chart onto the globe. Rather than examining planets in houses and signs as in a standard natal chart, astrocartography shows where specific planetary energies are strongest *geographically*.

ORIGIN

The technique was developed by astrologer **Jim Lewis** in the 1970s. Lewis took centuries of locational astrology theory and turned it into a visual, practical tool: a world map overlaid with personalised planetary lines. He coined the term Astro*Carto*Graphy, built the first software with programmer Michael Erlewine, and received a patent for his overlay method in 1981. His book *The Psychology of Astro*Carto*Graphy* (co-written with Kenneth Irving) remains a foundational text. He received the Regulus Award for Discovery, Innovation, and Research in 1992. This technique has been studied and practiced for decades.

HOW IT WORKS

The planets were in specific positions when you were born. Depending on where you are on Earth, those planets align with different angular points in your chart. Some cities activate your Venus line, which governs love and con-

nection. Some activate your Saturn line, which brings structure and harder lessons. The map shows you all of it at once.

Your birth chart is calculated for your birth *location*. When you move, the planets shift position relative to your new location. Astrocartography visualises that shift.

APPLICATIONS

USE CASE	WHAT ASTROCARTOGRAPHY REVEALS
Relocation planning	Which cities align with your career, relationship, or personal growth priorities
Travel	Why certain destinations resonate more strongly than others
Retrospective analysis	Why you thrived in one city and struggled in another
Decision support	An additional data point when weighing relocation options

This is not about finding one "perfect" city. Every location has trade-offs. The goal is to understand what each place activates so you can choose consciously.



2. How to Generate Your Chart

REQUIREMENTS

INPUT	WHY IT MATTERS
Birth date	Determines planetary positions
Birth time	Angles move ~1 degree every 4 minutes. A 30-minute error shifts lines by hundreds of miles.
Birth location	Baseline for calculating your planetary line positions

If you don't know your exact birth time: check your birth certificate, ask family members, or request hospital records. If unavailable, you can still use astrocartography, but treat exact line positions as approximate.

RECOMMENDED TOOLS

Astro.com (gold standard):

1. Create a free account at astro.com
2. Enter birth date, exact time, and location under "My Astro"
3. Navigate to Free Horoscopes > Astro Click Travel
4. Your map appears with all planetary lines overlaid
5. Click any location to see which lines are active

Astro-Seek.com (strong alternative):

1. Go to Astro-Seek.com
2. Navigate to the Astrocartography tool under Horoscopes
3. Enter your birth details to generate a clear visual map with built-in relocated chart tools

Both are accurate. Astro.com offers a more polished interactive experience; Astro-Seek provides more tools in one place, including relocated chart generation.

Generate your chart now. The rest of this guide assumes you have it open.



3. Anatomy of the Map

When you open your astrocartography map, you'll see a world map with coloured lines running across it. Some are straight (vertical), some are curved. Each line represents a planet, and each line type represents an angle.

WHAT YOU'RE SEEING

Lines are colour-coded by planet. Each planet gets its own colour (varies by tool, always labelled). You'll see lines for all major celestial bodies: Sun, Moon,

Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, Neptune, and Pluto.

Each planet has four lines, one per angle:

LINE TYPE	ANGLE	APPEARANCE
MC	Midheaven	Vertical (straight)
IC	Imum Coeli / Nadir	Vertical (straight)
AC	Ascendant	Curved
DC	Descendant	Curved

10 planets x 4 lines = 40 lines on your map. You don't need to read all 40 at once.

WHERE TO FOCUS FIRST

Start with the planet that matches your current priority:

PRIORITY	FOCUS ON
Love and relationships	♀ Venus and ☾ Moon lines
Career and public life	☼ Sun and ♃ Jupiter lines
Growth and opportunity	♃ Jupiter lines
Communication and learning	☿ Mercury lines
Drive and ambition	♂ Mars lines
Home and emotional wellbeing	☾ Moon lines

Find those lines on your map. Note which cities and countries they pass through.

PART II

The Building Blocks

4. The Four Angles

The angles are the backbone of astrocartography. They determine *how* a planet's energy shows up in a location.

The planet is the *what*. The angle is the *where in your life*.



MC: MIDHEAVEN

DOMAIN	Career, public life, reputation
LINE TYPE	Vertical
VISIBILITY	Very public

The Midheaven is the highest point in your chart. It represents your public face, career, reputation, and how the world sees you.

MC lines run straight up and down, marking the longitude where a planet was at its highest point in the sky at the moment of your birth. When a planet is on your MC in a location, that planet's energy is front and centre in your professional and public life there.

MC energy manifests as: being seen, being known for something, career activation, public recognition, stepping into a visible role.



IC: IMUM COELI (NADIR)

DOMAIN Home, roots, inner life

LINE TYPE Vertical

VISIBILITY Very private

The IC is the deepest, most private point in your chart, opposite the MC. It represents your inner world, your sense of home, your roots, and your emotional foundation.

IC lines run vertically, exactly 180 degrees from the MC line. When a planet is on your IC, that energy operates in your private life. It shapes how you feel at home, your relationship with family, and your inner emotional landscape.

IC energy manifests as: coming home, emotional depth, private transformation, inner knowing, ancestral connection.

The IC is frequently overlooked. It shouldn't be. Where you feel genuinely at home affects everything else. A strong IC placement can be the foundation that makes career, relationships, and personal growth possible.



AC: ASCENDANT

DOMAIN Self-image, identity, first impressions

LINE TYPE Curved

VISIBILITY Personal, visible to others

The Ascendant is your rising sign energy: how you come across to others, your outward personality, and the lens through which you experience the world.

AC lines are curved because they trace where a planet was rising on the eastern horizon. The curve occurs because the horizon angle changes with latitude. (Technically: AC lines are computed from the hour angle and declination of

each planet at each latitude. MC/IC lines are simpler, based purely on longitude.)

When a planet is on your AC, it colours your entire self-expression in that location.

AC energy manifests as: shifts in self-perception, changed personal magnetism, feeling like a different version of yourself.



DC: DESCENDANT

DOMAIN	Relationships, partnerships, one-on-one connections
LINE TYPE	Curved
VISIBILITY	Experienced through others

The Descendant is opposite the Ascendant. It represents other people, partnerships, and what you attract. This includes romantic partners, business partners, close friends, and anyone you form a significant one-on-one bond with.

DC lines are curved, opposite the AC curves. When a planet is on your DC, it shapes the kind of people you attract and the quality of your relationships in that location.

DC energy manifests as: attracting a particular type of person, relationship shifts, significant encounters, changed partnership dynamics.



ANGLE HIERARCHY

Among practitioners, the angles are generally ranked by intensity:

RANK	ANGLE	WHY
1	MC	Governs your most visible, public-facing life. Strongest angular point in traditional astrology.
2	AC	Fundamentally shifts how you present yourself and how others perceive you.
3	DC	Directly shapes relationship quality and partner attraction.
4	IC	Quietest in terms of external visibility, but arguably the most foundational.

Intensity and importance are not the same thing. Your IC line might not be the loudest, but it could be the one that matters most.

5. The Planets

Each planet carries a specific type of energy. When it lands on an angle in a location, it activates that energy in that area of your life.

INNER PLANETS (PERSONAL, DIRECT, FELT QUICKLY)

☉ Sun — Core Identity

GOVERNS	Identity, recognition, leadership, vitality, purpose
WHERE IT RUNS	You feel more <i>yourself</i> . Clarity about who you are and what you're here to do. People see and recognise something real in you.

☾ Moon — Emotional Self

GOVERNS	Emotions, comfort, intuition, home, nurturing, belonging
WHERE IT RUNS	Your emotional life is amplified. You feel things more deeply. Can feel like coming home, or can feel overwhelming, depending on the angle.

☿ Mercury — Mind and Communication

GOVERNS	Communication, ideas, learning, networking, mental clarity, writing
WHERE IT RUNS	Your mind is sharper. Conversations flow. You may pick up languages faster or find yourself surrounded by intellectually stimulating people.

♀ Venus — Love and Beauty

GOVERNS	Love, attraction, beauty, harmony, pleasure, social grace, magnetism
WHERE IT RUNS	Life feels more beautiful. You're more attractive to others and attracted to your surroundings. Romance and social situations flow more easily.

♂ Mars — Drive and Action

GOVERNS	Ambition, drive, courage, energy, competition, action, passion
WHERE IT RUNS	You feel more motivated, assertive, and willing to take risks. The other side: conflict can also increase. Mars energy is direct.

SOCIAL PLANETS

♃ Jupiter — Expansion and Luck

GOVERNS	Opportunity, growth, luck, abundance, expansion, optimism, generosity
WHERE IT RUNS	Things tend to work out. Doors open. Opportunities appear. An expansiveness to life that's hard to manufacture elsewhere.

♄ Saturn — Structure and Hard Lessons

GOVERNS	Discipline, responsibility, structure, challenges, maturity, authority
WHERE IT RUNS	Life asks more of you. Pressure to take responsibility and build something real. Demanding, but what you build here tends to last.

OUTER PLANETS (GENERATIONAL, SLOWER, DEEPER)

PLANET	SYMBOL	ENERGY	NOTE
Uranus	♅	Sudden change, innovation, freedom, disruption	Supportive for reinvention, less so for stability
Neptune	♆	Dreams, spirituality, illusion, creativity	Supportive for creative/spiritual pursuits, but can blur clarity
Pluto	♇	Transformation, power, intensity, deep psychological shifts	Heavy energy that should be approached with awareness

PLANETARY WEIGHT

Not all lines carry equal weight. In practice, most relocational astrologers rank planetary impact roughly as follows:

TIER	PLANETS	RELATIVE IMPACT
Highest	☉ Sun, ☾ Moon	Most personally impactful
High	♀ Venus, ♃ Jupiter	Traditional "benefics"
Moderate	♂ Mars, ♄ Saturn	Significant but more challenging
Lower	☿ Mercury	Important for communication/intellect specifically
Contextual	♅ Uranus, ♆ Neptune, ♇ Pluto	Slower-moving, generational, subtler effects

Context matters. A writer evaluating cities for a writing career should weight ☿ Mercury MC more heavily than this general ranking suggests.

This guide focuses primarily on ☉ Sun, ☾ Moon, ☿ Mercury, ♀ Venus, ♂ Mars, ♃ Jupiter, and ♄ Saturn. These are the most personally relevant planets. Your map includes all of them, and you now know what each one brings.

6. Planet + Angle Interpretations

This is the core reference section of the guide. Each planet + angle combination creates a specific experience in that location.

This is the section you'll return to most.



☉ SUN LINES

☉ Sun MC — Identity and Public Recognition

SUMMARY High visibility and recognition for who you truly are

THEMES Public recognition · Leadership · Career visibility

The Sun on your Midheaven means this is a place where you are highly visible. Your core identity is on display, and there is potential for recognition, leadership, and being known for who you truly are. You naturally command attention here. Career-wise, this supports stepping into authority and being seen for your contributions.

☉ Sun IC — Inner Foundation and Roots

SUMMARY A place for building a strong inner foundation and sense of home

THEMES Inner foundation · Sense of belonging · Self-knowledge

With the Sun on your IC, this location activates your deepest sense of self and belonging. You may feel drawn to put down roots here, create a home that truly reflects your identity, or reconnect with family heritage. Less about external achievement, more about knowing who you are at your core.

☉ Sun AC — Authentic Self-Expression

SUMMARY Your authentic self shines through in how you present yourself

THEMES Authentic expression · Natural confidence · Personal vitality

The Sun on your Ascendant brings vitality and authenticity to how you appear to others. You come across as confident, warm, and genuinely yourself. People are drawn to your natural radiance. This placement supports leadership, creative self-expression, and making a strong impression.

☉ Sun DC — Significant Partnerships

SUMMARY Relationships take centre stage, attracting powerful partners

THEMES Powerful connections · Significant partners · Relationship growth

With the Sun on your Descendant, relationships become a primary focus. You may attract partners who are confident, successful, or leadership-oriented. A location where significant partnerships can form and where you may define yourself through your connections with others.

Sun lines are where you feel most like yourself. Whether through career visibility (MC), inner knowing (IC), authentic presence (AC), or meaningful partnership (DC), these locations illuminate who you are at your core.



☾ MOON LINES

☾ Moon MC — Emotional Public Image

SUMMARY Your emotional nature becomes visible in your public life

THEMES Emotional intelligence · Nurturing career · Empathic leadership

The Moon on your Midheaven brings your emotional nature into your public and professional life. You may be drawn to nurturing careers or roles that involve caring for others. Your reputation may be tied to your emotional authenticity. Supports work in counselling, hospitality, or any field requiring emotional intelligence.

› Moon IC — Emotional Homeland

SUMMARY A place that feels deeply like home to your emotional self

THEMES Emotional homeland · Deep comfort · Belonging

With the Moon on your IC, this location touches the deepest part of your emotional nature. It may feel instinctively like home, activating memories, comfort, and a sense of belonging. One of the strongest placements for creating a nurturing home environment and connecting with family or chosen family.

› Moon AC — Emotional Presence

SUMMARY Your emotional nature is visible and magnetic to others

THEMES Emotional magnetism · Intuitive presence · Deep connections

With the Moon near your Ascendant line, your emotional nature is visible to others. You come across as nurturing, intuitive, and emotionally attuned. People sense your feelings easily. This can create deep connections but also vulnerability. Supports emotional intimacy in relationships.

› Moon DC — Emotional Partnerships

SUMMARY Draws emotionally nurturing and intuitive partners

THEMES Emotional intimacy · Nurturing partners · Soul connections

The Moon on your Descendant enhances emotional connections in relationships. You may attract nurturing, sensitive, or family-oriented partners. Relationships here tend to be emotionally rich and instinctive. A place where you might find someone who truly understands your emotional needs.

Moon lines are where you feel most emotionally alive. These locations touch something deep and instinctive. You may not be able to explain why a place feels like home, why a connection feels like recognition. That's the Moon at work.

☿ MERCURY LINES

☿ Mercury MC — Communication and Career

SUMMARY Enhanced communication skills in professional settings

THEMES Communication · Intellectual career · Mental clarity

Mercury on the Midheaven brings intellectual clarity to your career and public life. You may be drawn to communication-heavy fields: writing, teaching, media, or commerce. Your reputation may be built on your ideas and how well you articulate them. Mental agility is your professional asset here.

☿ Mercury IC — Intellectual Roots

SUMMARY A place for deep learning and intellectual reflection

THEMES Deep learning · Reflective thinking · Inner dialogue

Mercury on your IC activates intellectual curiosity in your private life. You may find yourself reading more, studying, or engaging in deep conversations at home. Supports writing, learning, and processing ideas in a quiet, reflective environment.

☿ Mercury AC — Quick-Witted Presence

SUMMARY Projects intellectual curiosity and communicative energy

THEMES Quick wit · Networking · Curious energy

Mercury on your Ascendant makes you come across as articulate, curious, and mentally sharp. You naturally engage others in conversation and process information quickly. Supports networking, learning, and making connections.

☿ Mercury DC — Intellectual Partnerships

SUMMARY Attracts partners through mental connection and conversation

THEMES Mental connection · Stimulating partners · Shared ideas

Mercury on your Descendant brings intellectual stimulation to relationships. You may attract communicative, witty, or intellectually curious partners. Relationships here are built on conversation and shared ideas.

Mercury lines sharpen the mind. Whether through career recognition (MC), deep study (IC), quick-witted presence (AC), or stimulating partnerships (DC), these locations put your intellect to work in ways that feel natural and rewarding.



♀ VENUS LINES

♀ Venus MC — Charm and Social Success

SUMMARY Enhanced social magnetism and appreciation in public life

THEMES Social magnetism · Creative recognition · Grace

Venus on the Midheaven tends to enhance how others perceive you socially. You may come across as more charming, warm, and magnetic here. This placement can heighten your social appeal and make it easier to draw positive attention. May support romantic connection through career, social circles, or public life.

♀ Venus IC — Beautiful Home Life

SUMMARY Creates harmony and beauty in your private life and home

THEMES Harmonious home · Beauty and comfort · Inner peace

With Venus on your IC, this location supports creating a beautiful, harmonious home life. You may be drawn to making your living space aesthetically pleasing and comfortable. Relationships with family may be more harmonious here. A place for cultivating pleasure and beauty in your private sphere.

♀ Venus AC — Personal Magnetism

SUMMARY Enhanced attractiveness and natural charm in how you present

THEMES Personal magnetism · Natural charm · Aesthetic sense

Venus on your Ascendant enhances your personal magnetism and attractiveness. You naturally come across as pleasant, charming, and aesthetically aware. People are drawn to you easily. Supports romance, social success, and anything requiring personal appeal.

♀ Venus DC — Romantic Magnetism

SUMMARY Creates receptive conditions for romantic connection

THEMES Romantic magnetism · Harmonious love · Deep attraction

One of the most favourable placements for love and partnership. Venus DC creates receptive conditions for romantic connection. You may find yourself more attractive to others and drawn to partners with artistic, affectionate qualities. Relationships formed here tend to be harmonious and mutually appreciative.

Venus lines soften the edges. Whether through social magnetism (MC), a beautiful home life (IC), personal charm (AC), or romantic connection (DC), these locations invite grace, beauty, and love into your experience.

‡ MARS LINES

‡ Mars MC — Drive and Ambition

SUMMARY Intense drive and ambition in career pursuits

THEMES Ambition · Career drive · Competitive edge

Mars on the Midheaven brings intense energy to your career and public life. You will feel driven, ambitious, and motivated to achieve. Mars here can fuel professional accomplishment through sheer force of will and action. The other side: competition. Mars MC can attract rivalry or power struggles in professional settings.

‡ Mars IC — Inner Fire

SUMMARY Activates deep passion and may stir family dynamics

THEMES Inner fire · Transformation · Deep motivation

Mars on your IC activates energy in your private life and home. You may feel more restless at home, driven to improve or change your living situation. Family dynamics may be more intense. Channel this energy into home improvement or personal development and it becomes fuel.

‡ Mars AC — Dynamic Presence

SUMMARY Projects courage, energy, and assertive presence

THEMES Dynamic presence · Physical vitality · Bold initiative

Mars on your Ascendant gives you a dynamic, assertive presence. You come across as energetic, courageous, and direct. Enhances physical vitality and the ability to take initiative. You may be drawn to competitive activities or leadership roles.

‡ Mars DC — Passionate Relationships

SUMMARY Attracts passionate, assertive partners with intensity

THEMES Passionate chemistry · Intensity · Electric bonds

Mars on your Descendant brings passion and intensity to relationships. You may attract dynamic, assertive, or competitive partners. Relationships here tend to be energetic and stimulating but may also involve conflict. Can indicate passionate romance or business partnerships with driven individuals.

Mars lines bring heat. Whether through career ambition (MC), inner drive (IC), dynamic presence (AC), or passionate partnerships (DC), these locations demand action. The energy is intense, but what you build under Mars is earned.



❧ JUPITER LINES

❧ Jupiter MC — Career Expansion and Luck

SUMMARY One of the most favourable placements for professional growth

THEMES Career expansion · Professional luck · Abundance

Jupiter on the Midheaven is one of the most favourable placements for professional growth and public recognition. This energy tends to support opportunity and expansion. Your efforts may feel more amplified and rewarded here than elsewhere. Supports growth, optimism, and a sense of abundance in your public life.

❧ Jupiter IC — Abundant Home Life

SUMMARY Brings expansion and optimism to home and inner life

THEMES Abundant home · Emotional growth · Inner wisdom

Jupiter on your IC brings expansion and optimism to your home and inner life. You may feel a sense of abundance in your private sphere, with a generous, welcoming home environment. Supports emotional growth, philosophical reflection, and a positive family life.

❧ Jupiter AC — Optimistic Presence

SUMMARY Projects warmth, generosity, and opens doors easily

THEMES Optimistic presence · Open doors · Good fortune

Jupiter on your Ascendant brings warmth, optimism, and openness to how you present yourself. Doors tend to open more easily. Others perceive you as generous and adventurous. Enhances your ability to make positive first impressions and attracts good fortune through your personality.

4 Jupiter DC — Fortunate Partnerships

SUMMARY Attracts beneficial, generous partners and opportunities through others

THEMES Fortunate partnerships · Generous partners · Lucky connections

Jupiter on your Descendant brings good fortune through partnerships and relationships. You may attract generous, optimistic, or successful partners. Opportunities often come through other people. Excellent for beneficial business partnerships and relationships that expand your horizons.

Jupiter lines expand everything they touch. Whether through career growth (MC), an abundant home (IC), optimistic presence (AC), or fortunate partnerships (DC), these locations feel like the universe is working with you, not against you.

♄ SATURN LINES

Saturn has a difficult reputation in astrocartography. But these are locations where life asks more of you, and where what you build tends to last.

♄ Saturn MC — Authority and Career Building

SUMMARY Slow career building through discipline and earned authority

THEMES Authority · Discipline · Long-term career building

You won't be handed anything here, but what you earn, you keep. Often associated with working under strict structures or eventually becoming an authority figure. Not quick wins. Real ones.

♄ Saturn IC — Emotional Foundations

SUMMARY Sense of duty around home; deep foundations built over time

THEMES Emotional maturity · Duty · Solid foundations

Emotional restriction or a sense of duty around home and family. Can feel isolating at first. But it can also indicate a place where you build deep, lasting emotional foundations. The comfort comes with time, not instantly.

♄ Saturn AC — Reserved Presence

SUMMARY Projects maturity and seriousness; first impressions require more effort

THEMES Maturity · Reserved presence · Earned respect

You may feel held back, more serious, or less "yourself" here initially. People perceive you as mature and responsible. First impressions may be harder to make, but the ones that stick are real.

♄ Saturn DC — Serious Partnerships

SUMMARY Relationships require genuine effort but develop into something solid

THEMES Serious partnerships · Commitment · Depth through effort

Relationships here require work. You may attract older, more serious, or emotionally cautious partners. But the relationships that survive are solid and mature. Saturn demands genuine effort, and what develops tends to be meaningful.

On Saturn lines generally: *These aren't locations for ease. They're where you do the work. If you're in a chapter of life where you're ready to build something serious, Saturn lines can be deeply rewarding. If you need lightness and recovery, they may not be the right fit right now. But don't dismiss them entirely.*

Advanced Reading

7. Orbs and Distance

You don't have to be *exactly* on a line for it to affect you. The influence fades gradually with distance. This zone of influence is called the "orb."

WHAT THE EXPERTS SAY

There is active debate among practitioners about effective orb distance:

SOURCE	RECOMMENDED ORB	EQUIVALENT DISTANCE
Jim Lewis (original technique)	8-12 degrees	~550-830 miles
Helena Woods (modern practitioner)	4-8 degrees	~350-600 miles
Contemporary consensus	4-6 degrees for strong effects	~200-350 miles
Client/community reports (Astrocartology forums)	Tightest ranges	Intense within 25 mi, strong within 50, noticeable within 100

WORKING FRAMEWORK

DISTANCE FROM LINE	STRENGTH	DESCRIPTION
0-50 miles (0-80 km)	Very strong	Unmistakable influence
50-150 miles (80-240 km)	Strong	Clearly noticeable, significant
150-350 miles (240-560 km)	Moderate	Present but softer, background influence
350-600 miles (560-960 km)	Mild	Lewis would say active; many modern astrologers say fading
600+ miles (960+ km)	Negligible	Most practitioners would not factor this in

PRACTICAL IMPLICATIONS

- A city 50 miles from your ♃ Jupiter MC line is a very strong ♃ Jupiter MC location
- You don't need to be exactly on the line. Within 150 miles, you're solidly in the zone
- Benefics (♃ Jupiter, ♀ Venus) may have wider effective ranges than malefics (♂ Mars, ♄ Saturn), though this is observational, not proven

DISTANCE AS INTENSITY

Being right on a line means the energy is at full strength. For ♃ Jupiter and ♀ Venus, that's generally welcome. For ♂ Mars or ♄ Saturn, full strength can be overwhelming. Some practitioners recommend living 150-300 miles from a challenging line to benefit from the energy without being consumed by it.

Think of distance as a volume dial. Full volume isn't always what serves you best.



8. Line Crossings and Power Zones

A **line crossing** occurs when two planetary lines intersect at the same location. Both planetary energies activate simultaneously, combining and amplifying each other.

TECHNICAL BACKGROUND: PARANS

The technical term for these crossings is **parans** (short for paranatellontae). When two lines cross, they create a horizontal latitude line extending east-west from the crossing point. The combined energy runs along that entire latitude, though it is strongest at and near the actual intersection, with an orb of approximately 1 degree of latitude (~70 miles north or south).

Parans are considered very powerful in locational astrology. Even without major planetary lines in your area, you almost certainly have paran lines nearby.

HOW TO IDENTIFY CROSSINGS

On Astro.com's Astro Click Travel, click directly on crossing points to see which planets are involved. Astro-Seek also displays paran lines clearly.

FAVOURABLE CROSSINGS

CROSSING	COMBINED ENERGY
♀ Venus + ♃ Jupiter	Love + luck + beauty + abundance. One of the most favourable crossings possible.
☉ Sun + ♃ Jupiter	Career success + expansion. Excellent for professional growth.
☾ Moon + ♀ Venus	Emotional comfort + beauty + love. Strong for home and relationships.
☿ Mercury + ♃ Jupiter	Ideas + opportunity. Strong for entrepreneurs, writers, communicators.

CHALLENGING CROSSINGS

CROSSING	COMBINED ENERGY
♂ Mars + ♄ Saturn	Drive + restriction. Hard work, sometimes frustrating. What you build is solid.
♂ Mars + ♇ Pluto	Intense power dynamics. Transformative but potentially volatile.
♄ Saturn + ♇ Pluto	Deep transformation through difficulty. Life-changing but heavy.
♆ Neptune + any	Inspiring and disorienting. Dreamlike quality but reduced clarity.

THE POWER ZONE

The area within ~100-150 miles of a crossing is the "power zone." Both energies are active here. The city closest to the intersection feels both influences most strongly.

From client work: A client had ♀ Venus DC and ♃ Jupiter AC lines crossing through Eastern China. Romantic connection (♀ Venus DC) was supported by warmth and openness (♃ Jupiter AC). They also had ♄ Saturn AC running through the same region, adding seriousness. The read: love here wouldn't be effortless, but what developed would be meaningful. ♃ Jupiter made them approachable, ♀ Venus made connection likely, ♄ Saturn ensured it wasn't superficial.

9. The Relocated Chart

This is the difference between a surface-level reading and understanding what a city will actually feel like day to day.

WHAT IS A RELOCATED CHART?

Your natal chart is calculated for your birth location. A relocated chart recalculates the same chart as if you were born at the exact same moment, but in a different city. The planets stay in the same signs (your cosmic blueprint doesn't change), but the **houses and angles shift**.

As astrologer Alice Bell explains: while the astrocartography map only shows when planets meet up with the four angles, the relocation chart shows what houses all your planets shift into, even if they aren't touching angles. This is a crucial distinction.

Houses determine *where in your life* planets express themselves. A planet in your 12th house (hidden, private) behaves very differently from the same planet in your 1st house (visible, front and centre) or your 7th house (through partnerships).

ASTROCARTOGRAPHY VS. RELOCATED CHART

	ASTROCARTOGRAPHY	RELOCATED CHART
Shows	Where planets meet the 4 angles	Where all planets land in houses
Scope	Global overview	City-specific detail
Best for	Identifying promising regions	Evaluating a specific city deeply
Analogy	Satellite view	Street-level view

HOW TO GENERATE

Astro.com: Go to your natal chart and change the birth location to your target city. Keep date and time the same.

Astro-Seek.com: Use the dedicated "Relocation Chart" tool.

WHAT TO EXAMINE

ELEMENT	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
New Ascendant	How you come across in this city. Your outward energy shifts.
Moon's house	Where you find emotional comfort. 4th = home/family. 7th = partnership. 11th = community.
Sun's house	Where your identity expresses most naturally. 10th = career-central. 12th = introspective.
New MC sign	What kind of career energy the city supports.
Planets in 7th house	Directly shapes relationship experience. ♀ Moon = emotional partnerships. ♄ Saturn = committed but slow. ♆ Neptune = fated but clarity needed.

WHEN TO USE IT

For a quick check, the astrocartography map is sufficient. For a serious relocation decision, pull up the relocated chart as well. It reveals things the map alone cannot.

PART IV

Application

10. City Evaluation Framework

A structured process for evaluating any city on your chart.

STEP	ACTION
1	Identify nearest lines. Which planets, which angles, approximate distance from each.
2	Check for crossings. Are any lines crossing near this city? Note both planets.
3	Read the interpretations. Refer to Section 6. Record key themes for each active line.
4	Assess angle relevance. Does the angle match what you're looking for? MC = career. IC = home. AC = identity. DC = relationships.
5	Factor in distance. Use the framework from Section 7 to gauge strength.
6	Check for challenging lines. Does the city also activate ♂ Mars or ♄ Saturn lines? Note the full picture.
7	Pull the relocated chart (optional). For serious consideration: new Ascendant, Moon's house, planets in 7th house, new MC sign.
8	Reality check. Visa, cost of living, language, climate, job market. Both lenses matter.



11. The Relocation Decision Framework

STEP 1: DEFINE YOUR PRIORITY

What is your primary goal for your next chapter? You can want more than one thing, but knowing which one leads helps you weight the lines.

PRIORITY	BEST LINES
Career advancement	☉ Sun MC · ♃ Jupiter MC · ♂ Mars MC
Finding love	♀ Venus DC · ♀ Venus AC · ☾ Moon DC
Feeling at home	☾ Moon IC · ♀ Venus IC · ♃ Jupiter IC
Personal growth	♃ Jupiter AC · ☉ Sun AC
Creative expression	♀ Venus MC · ♆ Neptune AC · ☉ Sun AC
Building wealth	♃ Jupiter MC · ☉ Sun MC · ♄ Saturn MC (long game)
Intellectual stimulation	☿ Mercury MC · ☿ Mercury AC · ♃ Jupiter AC
Fresh start	♅ Uranus AC · ♇ Pluto AC · ☉ Sun AC

STEP 2: THREE-CITY METHOD

Identify your top three cities based on priority lines. For each:

Map out:

- Active lines (planet + angle)
- Distance from each line
- Any crossings
- Overall "signature" from interpretations

Score:

- Alignment with your #1 priority (strong / moderate / weak)
- Challenging lines present (noted honestly)
- Practical feasibility (visa, cost, language, climate)

STEP 3: PRACTICAL OVERLAY

Astrocartography is one input, not the only one. A city with ideal planetary alignment but no job market in your field, an impossible visa situation, or a climate that genuinely doesn't suit you is still not the right city.

Use astrocartography as a **filter and a tiebreaker**:

1. Start with your practical shortlist — cities you could actually move to
2. Overlay your astrocartography — which of these have the best activations?
3. Visit first if possible — spend a week or two there
4. Trust your body — if a city with great lines doesn't feel right, that's data too

A NOTE ON TIMING

Planetary transits interact with your astrocartography lines. A city might feel average most years but activate powerfully during a specific transit period. If you work with transit astrology, layer it on top of your astrocartography reading for additional nuance.

12. Worked Example

SETUP

BORN	15 March 1995, 2:30 PM, London, UK
PRIORITY	Career growth and romantic connection

STEP 1: KEY LINES IDENTIFIED

CITY	LINE	DISTANCE	STRENGTH
Singapore	♃ Jupiter MC	~40 mi	Very strong
Barcelona	♀ Venus DC + ♃ Jupiter AC	~60 mi	Strong (power zone)
New York	☉ Sun MC	~80 mi	Strong
Melbourne	☾ Moon IC	~45 mi	Very strong

STEP 2: CROSSINGS

Near Barcelona, ♀ Venus DC and ♃ Jupiter AC lines cross within 100 miles. Power zone: romantic connection (♀ Venus DC) meets good fortune and warmth (♃ Jupiter AC).

STEP 3: INTERPRETATION SUMMARY

CITY	READING
Singapore	♃ Jupiter MC: One of the most favourable placements for professional growth. Doors opening, career expansion, abundance.
Barcelona	♀ Venus DC: Receptive conditions for romantic connection. + ♃ Jupiter AC: Warmth, openness, good fortune in self-presentation.
New York	☉ Sun MC: High visibility and recognition. Career leadership. People see the real you.
Melbourne	☾ Moon IC: Emotional homeland. A place that feels deeply like home.

STEP 4: PRIORITY MATCHING

GOAL	BEST FIT
Career	Singapore (♃ Jupiter MC) — premier career placement
Love	Barcelona (♀ Venus DC + ♃ Jupiter AC crossing) — clear standout
Foundation	Melbourne (♌ Moon IC) — emotional home base

STEP 5: DECISION

Target Singapore for the career chapter. Bookmark Barcelona for when romantic connection becomes the leading priority. Melbourne stays on the radar as a long-term home base.

This is astrocartography applied practically. A thoughtful framework layered onto real-world planning.

PART V

Reference

13. Quick Reference Tables

PLANETS AT A GLANCE

PLANET	SYMBOL	ENERGY	BEST FOR
Sun	☉	Identity, confidence, vitality	Career, leadership, being seen
Moon	☾	Emotions, comfort, intuition	Home, belonging, emotional wellbeing
Mercury	☿	Communication, intellect	Networking, learning, writing
Venus	♀	Love, beauty, attraction	Romance, social life, creativity
Mars	♂	Drive, ambition, energy	Career drive, action, initiative
Jupiter	♃	Growth, luck, abundance	Career expansion, opportunity
Saturn	♄	Discipline, structure	Long-term building, authority, mastery

ANGLES AT A GLANCE

ANGLE	DOMAIN	VISIBILITY	LINE TYPE
MC	Career, public life	Very public	Vertical
IC	Home, inner life	Very private	Vertical
AC	Identity, presence	Personal	Curved
DC	Relationships	Through others	Curved

ALL 28 COMBINATIONS AT A GLANCE

PLANET	MC (CAREER)	IC (HOME)	AC (IDENTITY)	DC (RELATIONSHIPS)
☉ Sun	Visibility, leadership	Inner foundation	Authentic presence	Significant partners
☾ Moon	Emotional public image	Emotional homeland	Emotional magnetism	Nurturing partners
☿ Mercury	Intellectual career	Deep learning	Quick-witted presence	Mental connection
♀ Venus	Social magnetism	Beautiful home	Personal charm	Romantic magnetism
♂ Mars	Ambitious drive	Inner fire	Dynamic presence	Passionate bonds
♃ Jupiter	Career expansion	Abundant home	Optimistic presence	Fortunate partners
♄ Saturn	Earned authority	Solid foundations	Reserved maturity	Serious commitment

LINES TO APPROACH WITH AWARENESS

LINE	NOTE
♄ Saturn	Growth through challenge. Slow but solid.
♂ Mars	Energy and drive, plus potential conflict.
♅ Pluto	Deep transformation. Intense.
♆ Neptune	Inspiring but hazy. Verify, don't assume.

14. Common Mistakes

These come up often in client work. Worth knowing before you start making decisions.

1. Ignoring birth time accuracy

A 30-minute error can displace your AC and DC lines significantly. MC and IC lines are affected too, to a lesser degree. Get the most accurate birth time available before making decisions.

2. Only looking at favourable lines

Everyone gravitates toward their ♃ Jupiter MC. That's natural. But ignoring ♄ Saturn or ♂ Mars lines in a city means you're only seeing half the picture. Check all lines near any city you're seriously considering.

3. Treating one line as deterministic

A city with your ♀ Venus DC doesn't guarantee love. It means the *conditions* are more favourable. Astrocartography shows potential, not promises.

4. Relocating based solely on astrocartography

Don't uproot your life solely because a planetary line runs through a city. Factor in practical realities. Visit first. Astrocartography is a tool, not a directive.

5. Forgetting about transits

Your astrocartography map is fixed (based on your birth chart). But transiting planets interact with your relocated chart over time. A city might feel different during different periods.

6. Comparing charts with others

Your ♃ Jupiter line doesn't run through the same places as someone else's. Their map is irrelevant to yours.

7. Dismissing ♄ Saturn entirely

♄ Saturn lines aren't punishment. They're places where you grow through effort and discipline. Some of the most meaningful life chapters happen under ♄ Saturn lines. The question isn't "is ♄ Saturn there?" but "am I ready for what ♄ Saturn asks?"

8. Skipping the relocated chart

The astrocartography map is the overview. The relocated chart is the detail. For serious relocation decisions, use both.

15. Glossary

TERM	DEFINITION
Angle	One of four key chart points (MC, IC, AC, DC) where planetary energy shows up in specific life areas
Ascendant (AC)	Eastern horizon point. Governs self-image, identity, first impressions
Astrocartography	Branch of astrology mapping your birth chart onto the globe geographically
Descendant (DC)	Western horizon point. Governs relationships and partnerships
IC (Imum Coeli)	Lowest chart point. Governs home, roots, inner life. Also called the Nadir
Line crossing	Where two planetary lines intersect, combining both energies. Also called a paran
MC (Midheaven)	Highest chart point. Governs career, public life, reputation
Natal chart	Your birth chart, calculated for the exact time and place of birth
Orb	The distance from an exact line within which influence is felt
Paran	Where two planetary lines cross, creating a latitude band of combined energy
Planetary line	A line showing where a planet was at a specific angle at the time of your birth
Power zone	Area around a line crossing where both energies are active (~100–150 miles)
Relocated chart	Natal chart recalculated for a different location. Houses and angles shift
Transit	Current position of a planet interacting with your natal chart over time

16. Worksheets

Worksheet A: Priority Lines

My primary priority:

Lines to focus on:

#	PLANET	SYMBOL	ANGLE	WHY
1				
2				
3				

Worksheet B: City Evaluation

Use one copy per city.

City:

Active Lines:

PLANET	SYMBOL	ANGLE	DISTANCE	STRENGTH
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Line crossings nearby:

Key themes:

Relocated chart (optional):

ELEMENT	VALUE
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New Ascendant

Moon's house

Sun's house

Planets in 7th

New MC sign

Practical assessment:

FACTOR	RATING (1-5)	NOTES
Visa / legal		
Cost of living		
Language		
Job market		
Climate		
Overall assessment:		

Worksheet C: Three-City Comparison

	CITY 1: _____	CITY 2: _____	CITY 3: _____
Strongest line			
Distance from line			
Priority alignment	Strong / Mod / Weak	Strong / Mod / Weak	Strong / Mod / Weak
Challenging lines			
Practical feasibility	Strong / Mod / Weak	Strong / Mod / Weak	Strong / Mod / Weak
Gut feeling			
Recommended choice and rationale:			



What to Do Next

You now have the knowledge to read your own astrocartography chart. You understand the angles, the planets, every major combination, distance rules, line crossings, relocated charts, and how to put it all together into a practical evaluation.

As a first step: pull up your chart and find the city you currently live in. Read the lines. See if it matches your experience. That tends to be the moment where this shifts from theory to something personal.

Then look at the cities you've always felt drawn to. See what lines run through them. Notice if there's a pattern.

If you're seriously considering a move, work through the framework in Section 11 and use the worksheets. Take your time.

Your chart is a map. Where you go is still your choice.

Astrocartography shows where certain energies become more accessible. It does not determine outcomes. These are favourable conditions, not guarantees. What you do within those conditions is yours to decide.

17. Sources and Further Reading

BOOKS

- *The Psychology of Astro*Carto*Graphy* — Jim Lewis and Kenneth Irving. The foundational text.
- *The Astro*Carto*Graphy Book of Maps* — Jim Lewis. Case studies of famous people and their planetary lines.

TOOLS

TOOL	URL	USE
Astro.com	astro.com	Free interactive astrocartography map (gold standard)
Astro-Seek	astro-seek.com	Free map with relocated chart tools

ONLINE RESOURCES

SOURCE	TOPIC
Helena Woods — How to Read Your Astrocartography Map	Step-by-step walkthrough with visuals
Kim Mott — How to Read Your Astrocartography Map	Beginner-friendly breakdown
Kim Mott — History of Astrocartography	Jim Lewis and technique development
My Astro Diaries — Paran Lines Explained	Paran crossings and mechanics
My Astro Diaries — Astrocartography vs Relocation Chart	When to use each technique
Alice Bell — Astrocartography & Relocation Charts	Overview of both techniques
Sensitive Nomad — Intro to Astrocartography	Practical tips
Astrocartography.uk — Orbs of Influence	Technical orb distances

TECHNICAL REFERENCES

SOURCE	TOPIC
Jim Lewis — Wikipedia	Inventor biography and contributions
Astrology for the Soul — Locational Astrology	Technical dive into line calculations



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